Backtest → Paper → Live EOD Trading: Daily Operating Guide (India / NSE)

Oct 6, 2026 · @Dheerendra Kumar Yadav

Purpose and the one governing rule

Signals are always computed on adjusted prices; every rupee, share, order and fill is always handled in raw (unadjusted) prices. Every daily step below is an application of that rule.

This guide covers an EOD strategy on NSE cash equities: the decision is made after the close of day T, the order executes at the open of T+1. It walks through three stages — backtest, Paper EOD and Live EOD — and the two parallel runs that connect them:

- **Parallel run 1** — Backtest replay alongside Paper EOD. Proves your daily pipeline reproduces the backtest.
- **Parallel run 2** — Paper EOD alongside Live EOD. Measures what the real market takes away from the paper result.

Why two price series. An adjusted series removes the artificial jumps from splits, bonuses, dividends and rights, so indicators behave the way they did in the backtest. But the exchange, your broker, the circuit bands and your bank account only know raw prices. A 1:5 split on raw prices looks like an 80% crash; a ₹1,000 order sized on an adjusted price buys the wrong number of shares. Volume has the mirror-image problem: after a 1:5 split each rupee trades as five times as many shares, so past volume must be adjusted too (see Volume adjustment).

Why back-adjusted history must be rebuilt daily. A back-adjusted series is rescaled every time a new corporate action goes ex. The adjusted close you saved last month will be a different number next month. So in paper and live trading you rebuild the adjusted series every evening using only corporate actions with ex-date ⩽ T, and you never store adjusted prices in an order book, trade log or P&L ledger.

What stays the same across all three stages: the strategy code, its configuration, the flags library (circuit / staircase / MWCB / TRADE_BLOCKED) and the rule that row T means "as of the close of day T". What changes is only where prices come from and who decides whether a fill happened.

Which price series to use for what

Use adjusted prices only when a price is compared with its own past; use raw (unadjusted) prices whenever a price touches the outside world — the exchange, the broker, a rupee amount, a fixed rupee threshold, or your bank account.

The one-line test. Ask: "Is this number ever compared with something outside the stock's own history?" If yes, use raw. If it is only compared with itself over time (a return, a moving average, a ratio), use adjusted.

The three price series you will hold

Series	What it is	Built how	Used for
Raw (unadjusted)	Prices exactly as traded on that day, as in the NSE bhavcopy	Downloaded daily, never modified	Everything that involves rupees, orders, the exchange or the broker
Point-in-time adjusted (as of T)	History adjusted only for corporate actions with ex-date ⩽ T	Rebuilt every evening from raw files + corporate actions master	All signals in paper and live; the correct basis for any backtest feature
Back-adjusted (as of today)	Whole history adjusted for every action up to today, including ones that hadn't happened yet at earlier dates	Vendor style, e.g. your stitched Final_Data	Backtest returns and equity curves; never for price-level rules

Returns and ratios are identical in the point-in-time and back-adjusted series. Price levels are not: before a 1:5 split, the back-adjusted price is one-fifth of what anyone actually saw. That is why any rule using a rupee level must use raw or point-in-time data.

Use adjusted prices for

Purpose	Series	Notes
Returns (daily, weekly, momentum lookbacks)	Adjusted	Raw returns show a false crash on every split/bonus ex-date
Moving averages, RSI, MACD, Bollinger bands, ATR as a % of price	Adjusted	Any indicator built from a price history
Breakouts vs past highs/lows, 52-week high/low	Adjusted	A past high before a split is meaningless on raw prices
Volatility, beta, correlation, covariance	Adjusted returns	Feeds Card 12 sensitivity checks
Cross-sectional ranking on returns	Adjusted	Momentum, reversal and similar factors
Stop or target defined as % from entry	Adjusted to decide; raw to place	Decide with adjusted history; any resting order is placed at a raw price
Backtest equity curve and performance statistics	Back-adjusted (total return if dividends are included)	Must match how you will report live performance
Volume as a time series (average volume, volume spikes, the staircase thin-volume baseline)	Volume adjusted inversely: multiply past volume by the split/bonus ratio	Raw volume jumps 5× after a 1:5 split and looks like a spike

Use raw (unadjusted) prices for

Purpose	Series	Notes
Order quantity and position sizing	Raw close of T (× T+1 ex-date factor if any)	Shares × raw price = rupees actually spent
Limit prices for AMOs	Raw, inside the band, tick-rounded	The exchange rejects anything else

Purpose	Series	Notes
Price bands and circuit detection	Raw, with the exchange's adjusted base price on split/bonus/rights ex-dates	Ordinary dividends generally do not change the base price
Tick-size rounding	Raw, using the dated tick table	Tick slabs depend on the actual price level
Fill prices and slippage measurement	Raw official open of T+1 and raw broker fill	Slippage vs adjusted prices is meaningless
Mark-to-market, equity, P&L, cash ledger	Raw close	Must reconcile with the broker to the rupee
Costs (STT, stamp duty, exchange charges, GST, DP)	Raw traded value	Charged on what was actually traded
Reconciliation with broker holdings and tradebook	Raw	The broker only knows raw prices
Price-level filters (e.g. price > ₹20, penny-stock exclusion, high-priced stock skip)	Raw as of T	Back-adjusted prices here are look-ahead
Liquidity in rupees (traded value, days to exit)	Raw turnover from the bhavcopy	Rupee turnover is unaffected by splits
Market cap, free float, index weights	Raw price × actual shares	Feeds Card 5
Dividend amounts and yields	Raw	Declared per share on the raw share count
Comparing with news, circulars or broker screens	Raw	Every outside source quotes raw prices
Tax records and capital gains	Raw cost and sale prices, adjusted only as tax rules require for splits/bonus	Confirm treatment with your chartered accountant

By stage

- **Backtest:** signals from point-in-time adjusted data (or back-adjusted if every feature is return-based); price-level rules, bands and filters from raw data; equity curve from back-adjusted total return.
- **Paper EOD:** signals from the series rebuilt each evening as of T; fills, sizing, costs, ledger and reconciliation in raw.
- **Live EOD:** exactly as paper; the broker and exchange enforce raw prices on everything you send.

Your data and tools

- Your Final_Data is back-adjusted. Treat it as the research series for returns. Keep (or rebuild) a raw series beside it for bands, ticks, filters and sizing.
- The circuit flags library needs raw-price input (or ex-date-aware band calculation) for exact tick and band checks — this is open item 21 in the Gap analysis tab.
- Store only raw prices in any ledger, order file or log. Adjusted series are always rebuilt, never stored as records.

Volume adjustment

Volume needs the mirror image of price adjustment: when a split or bonus multiplies the number of shares by k, past volume must be multiplied by k, or every split looks like a k-fold volume spike and every 20-day volume average is wrong for 20 days.

Why it matters. After a 1:5 split (₹10 face value to ₹2), each old share becomes five new ones. The same rupee value now trades as five times as many shares. On raw data the ex-date shows volume jumping about 5× with nothing having happened. A rolling 20-day volume baseline is a blend of pre-split and post-split counts until the window has fully passed the ex-date.

The factors

Let k = shares after the action ÷ shares before. For every trading day t before the ex-date:

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P^{\text{adj}}_t = \frac{P^{\text{raw}}_t}{k} \qquad V^{\text{adj}}_t =
V^{\text{raw}}_t \times k \qquad P^{\text{adj}}_t \times V^{\text{adj}}_t =
P^{\text{raw}}_t \times V^{\text{raw}}_t
```

The last identity is the built-in test: rupee turnover is unchanged by a share-count adjustment.

Corporate action	k (share-count ratio)	Adjust past volume?	Example
Split (face value F_old → F_new)	F_old ÷ F_new	Yes, × k	₹10 → ₹2: past volume × 5
Bonus a:b (a new for every b held)	(a + b) ÷ b	Yes, × k	1:1 bonus: past volume × 2
Consolidation (reverse split)	F_old ÷ F_new, less than 1	Yes, × k	₹1 → ₹10: past volume × 0.1
Ordinary or special dividend	none	No	Value adjustment only; share count unchanged
Rights issue	not a fixed share-count change	No, by default	Subscription is uncertain; if your vendor adjusts it, match the backtest and document it
Merger / demerger	case by case	Case by case	Handle manually with the scheme's share ratio

Use the share-count ratio k for volume, not the price adjustment factor. For splits and bonuses they are exact inverses; for dividends and rights they are not, which is why dividends never touch volume.

What to adjust and what not

Series	Adjust?	Reason
Traded quantity (volume)	Yes	Counted in shares
Deliverable quantity	Yes	Counted in shares
Delivery % (deliverable ÷ traded)	No	A ratio; already split-invariant
Turnover / traded value (₹)	No	Rupees are unchanged by a split
Number of trades	No	A count of trades, not shares

Series	Adjust?	Reason
Shares outstanding / free-float shares	Use point-in-time actual counts	Needed raw for market cap and index weights

Where volume is used in this guide

- **Signals and features:** average volume, volume spikes, volume breakouts, on-balance volume, VWAP-style features (Card 7.10).
- **Your flags library:** the staircase thin-volume baseline (20-row volume baseline), the untag rule ("returns to normal with volume") and any volume condition in the chronic flag.
- **Order sizing:** the liquidity cap, order quantity ⩽ 1–2% of 20-day median volume (Card 8.7). Tomorrow's order is in post-split shares, so the median must be too.
- **Portfolio liquidity:** days to exit (Card 10.7) and the liquidity stress test (Card 12.8).
- **Paper fill rule:** the same-day volume cap compares an order with T+1's own volume; both are on the same share basis, so no adjustment is needed there.

The staircase flag in particular

The staircase logic compares each day's volume with a baseline of recent days. On raw volume around a 1:5 split, pre-split days in the baseline are 5× too small. The baseline is too low for up to 20 rows after the ex-date, so ordinary post-split volume looks heavy: thin-volume conditions are missed and an existing tag can be released early. In the reverse case (consolidation), normal volume looks thin and the stock can be wrongly tagged.

Run the flags library on split-adjusted volume, rebuilt as of T exactly like prices. Until that is confirmed, treat staircase and chronic results within 20 trading days after any split, bonus or consolidation as unverified. This is open item 29 in the Gap analysis tab.

Volume in the three series

- **Raw:** volume as printed in the bhavcopy. Use it only to reconcile with the exchange and for same-day comparisons (the paper fill cap).
- **Point-in-time adjusted (as of T):** rebuilt every evening with the price series, using only ex-dates ⩽ T. Used for every volume feature, flag and liquidity check.

- **Back-adjusted (your Final_Data):** check whether the vendor adjusted volume at all. Stitched data from several vendors may be inconsistent, with some months adjusted and others not.

Tests

- **Turnover identity:** for every split, bonus or consolidation in your history, adjusted price × adjusted volume equals raw turnover on pre-ex-date days (within rounding).
- **No artificial jump:** the ratio of volume on the ex-date to the 20-day median of adjusted volume is not near k, unless there was real news.
- **Vendor check:** on 5–10 known splits in Final_Data, compare the volume series around the ex-date with the NSE bhavcopy. If the vendor left volume raw, apply the factor yourself.
- **Flags check:** re-run staircase and chronic flags on adjusted volume for the stocks with splits or bonuses, and list every day whose tag changes. Each change was a false tag or a missed tag in the current output.

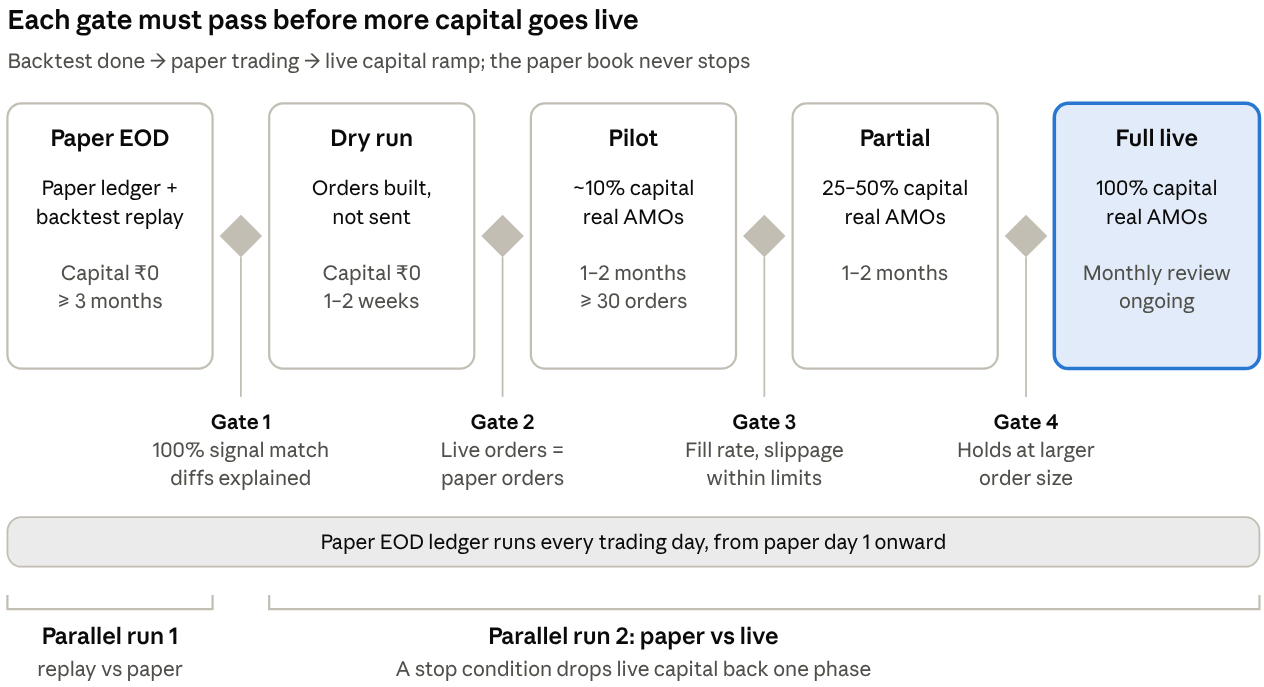
These tests appear as checks 3.10 and 7.10 in the evening cards.

The three stages at a glance

The strategy logic never changes between stages; what changes is the source of prices, who confirms the fill, and who handles corporate actions.

Aspect	Backtest	Paper EOD	Live EOD
When it runs	Once, over all history	Every trading evening + next morning	Every trading evening + next morning
Signal prices	Back-adjusted series (adjusted with all future actions)	Adjusted series rebuilt each evening with ex-date ⩽ T	Same as paper
Order prices and quantity	Usually implicit (weights)	Raw T close × any T+1 ex-date factor	Same as paper, plus band and tick checks enforced by exchange
Fill price	Assumed T+1 open (adjusted)	T+1 open from raw bhavcopy + modelled cost	Actual broker average fill price

Aspect	Backtest	Paper EOD	Live EOD
Who decides a fill happened	Your code	Your code, using bhavcopy and flags	Exchange and broker; you only read the result
Partial / unfilled orders	Rarely modelled	Modelled by rule (circuit lock, volume cap)	Real, must be reconciled every day
Splits / bonus	Hidden inside adjusted series	You adjust quantity and cost basis in the ledger	Depository adjusts holdings; you reconcile your ledger to it
Dividends	Hidden inside adjusted series (total return)	You credit cash on record date	Paid to your bank account, not the trading account
Costs	Assumed percentage	Itemised: STT, exchange, SEBI, stamp, GST, DP	From contract notes
Source of truth for positions	Backtest state	Paper ledger	Broker holdings and positions
Main risk	Overfitting, look-ahead	Pipeline bugs, corporate-action misses	Slippage, rejections, operational failure



roadmap · 5 phases, 4 gates, 2 parallel runs

The paper book starts on day 1 and never stops; live capital rises one phase at a time, and only after the gate before it passes.

Before paper trading starts: one-time setup

Do all of these once, before the first paper trading day; each one removes a common cause of paper results drifting from the backtest.

1. **Freeze the strategy.** Tag the exact strategy code, flags library version (e.g. QBEAST circuit flags v2.4.1) and config file. Record the commit hash or zip checksum. Any change after this point restarts Parallel run 1.
2. **Raw daily data source.** Use the official NSE CM bhavcopy (now published in the UDiFF format) as the primary raw source. Keep your broker's EOD data (Kite/Dhan/Upstox) as a cross-check only. Store every day's file untouched in an archive folder.
3. **Series filter.** Decide which series you trade (EQ, BE, BZ, etc.). BE/BZ are trade-for-trade segments with different rules; most EOD strategies trade EQ only. Apply the same filter as the backtest.
4. **Corporate actions master.** Build one table with: symbol, ISIN, action type, ratio or amount, announcement date, ex-date, record date. Sources: NSE corporate actions announcements, your broker, and your existing back-adjustment inputs. This table

drives both the adjusted series and the ledger adjustments.

5. **Adjustment-factor code.** One function that turns the master into multiplicative factors per ex-date:
   - Split a→b: factor = b/a on prices before the ex-date (e.g. ₹10→₹2 face value: factor 0.2).
   - Bonus a:b (a new for every b held): factor = b/(a+b).
   - Dividend D: factor = 1 − D / (raw close on the day before ex-date).
   - Rights: factor from the theoretical ex-rights price.
   - Volume: multiply volume (and deliverable quantity) before the ex-date by the share-count ratio k for splits, bonuses and consolidations; never for dividends; not for rights by default (see Volume adjustment). Use exactly the same function the backtest used, or Parallel run 1 will fail.
6. **Symbol and ISIN map.** Symbols change (renames, mergers). Key your data and ledger by ISIN internally, display by symbol. ISINs also change, typically on a face-value split, consolidation or scheme of arrangement, so keep a dated ISIN history map (old ISIN → new ISIN, effective date) and link price history across it.
7. **Trading calendar.** NSE holiday list for the year, plus a rule for special sessions (Muhurat trading, budget-day Saturday sessions). T+1 means "next trading day", never "next calendar day".
8. **Index data for MWCB.** Daily Nifty 50 (and Sensex if you track BSE) OHLC, so the MWCB flag can be computed the same way as in the backtest.
9. **F&O membership list.** Stocks in F&O have no fixed price band. Keep a dated list so the circuit flag uses “no band” for them.
10. **Ledger design.** Separate tables for: signals, orders, fills, positions, cash, corporate-action events, costs, daily equity. Every row keyed by trade date and ISIN. All prices raw.
11. **Cost model.** Itemise: brokerage, STT (delivery, both sides), exchange transaction charges, SEBI turnover fee, stamp duty (buy side), GST on brokerage + exchange charges, DP charge per scrip on sell. Rates change; keep them in config, not in code.
12. **Fill rules for paper.** Write down, before day 1, exactly when a paper order fills:
    - BUY at T+1 open fills unless the T+1 open is at the upper band price (tick-aware). This conservative rule treats any upper-circuit open as unfilled, because EOD data cannot show whether sellers existed at that price.
    - SELL at T+1 open fills unless the T+1 open is at the lower band price (tick-aware), by the same conservative logic.

    - Optional volume cap: order quantity ⩽ x% of T+1 traded volume (e.g. 1–2%), excess left unfilled.
    - Slippage model: e.g. a fixed bps add-on by liquidity bucket. Limit modelling: paper must use the same order type as live. Once live uses buffered limit orders, a paper buy is unfilled if the T+1 open is above its limit, and a paper sell is unfilled if the open is below its limit.
13. **Automation and logging.** One PowerShell-scheduled job per phase (evening run, morning fill run). Every run writes a dated log, the input file checksums and the output files. A run is only "done" when its output files exist and its checks pass.
14. **Starting capital and state.** Fix paper starting capital equal to what you intend to trade live (or a fixed multiple), and an empty starting portfolio date. Do not seed paper with backtest positions unless Parallel run 1 does the same.

Daily routine: Paper EOD trading

In paper trading everything happens in one evening run on each trading day D, because yesterday's orders can only be filled once today's bhavcopy (with today's open) is published. The order of steps inside that run matters: corporate actions going ex today first (on the shares held at yesterday's close), then yesterday's orders filled (already in post-action shares), then mark-to-market, then new signals.

Evening run on trading day D (after the bhavcopy is published)

Stage 1 — Data in and checked

1. Confirm D is a trading day per your calendar. If not, do nothing and log "holiday".
2. Download D's NSE CM bhavcopy. Save the untouched file to the archive with its checksum.
3. Validate it: row count within the normal range, no duplicate symbol+series rows, OHLC sane (low ⩽ open, close ⩽ high), no zero or negative prices, previous close matches yesterday's close for most symbols.
4. Download D's index data (Nifty 50 etc.) and any new corporate action announcements. Update the corporate actions master.
5. Cross-check a sample of closes against your broker's EOD data. Stop and investigate if anything disagrees.

Stage 2 — Corporate actions going ex on D (adjust before booking today's fills)

6. Load `exdate_<D>.csv`, saved last evening with each stock's price factor, k and the quantity held at the close of D−1. For each: split/bonus → that quantity × k, average cost and stop/target levels ÷ k; dividend → receivable on that quantity, even if the shares are sold today, credited on the payment date (or on the ex-date if you model it simply, consistently with Parallel run 1); rights → log the entitlement and apply your pre-written rule. Shares bought today are already post-action shares and are never adjusted.
7. Verify: for every split/bonus, the D−1 raw value equals the new quantity × the D−1 adjusted close. Shares not yet sellable (bonus shares, split shares awaiting a new-ISIN credit) stay on the pending-exits list if the strategy wants them sold.

Stage 3 — Settle yesterday's paper orders (placed on D−1 for execution on D, already in post-action shares)

8. For each pending order, read D's raw open from the bhavcopy.
9. Apply your written fill rules: blocked if UC-locked (buy) / LC-locked (sell) at open, or if your flags mark the stock TRADE_BLOCKED; open beyond the order's limit price; volume cap; otherwise filled. On an ex-date, circuit checks use the exchange's adjusted base price, not D−1's raw close.
10. Fill price = D's raw open + modelled slippage (buys pay more, sells receive less).
11. Compute itemised costs per fill. Update cash and positions in the paper ledger.
12. Record unfilled or partially filled quantity with a reason code (UC_LOCK, LC_LOCK, BLOCKED_FLAG, VOLUME_CAP, NO_TRADE).

Stage 4 — Mark to market

13. Value all positions at D's raw close. Write the daily equity row: cash, holdings value, receivables, total equity, daily return, cumulative costs.

Stage 5 — New signals for D+1

14. Rebuild the adjusted price and volume history for the full universe using only corporate actions with ex-date ⩽ D.
15. Run the flags library on the same data (split-adjusted volume included), as of the close of D: PRICE_BAND, CIRCUIT, MWCB, STAIRCASE, TRADE_BLOCKED.
16. Run the frozen strategy on the adjusted data. Output: target positions or signals as of close of D.
17. Save the signals file with D in its name. This file must never be overwritten later.

Stage 6 — Convert signals into raw-price orders for D+1

18. Compare target positions with current paper positions, first converting holdings of stocks going ex on D+1 to D+1 share terms (quantity × k). Produce buy and sell quantities. Save exdate_<D+1>.csv with each such stock′s price factor, k and the quantity held at the close of D.
19. Size quantities in rupees using raw prices: quantity = floor(rupee allocation ÷ reference price).
20. If D+1 is a known ex-date for that stock, multiply the reference price by the adjustment factor before sizing. Sells on an ex-date: dividend → sell normally (the dividend is still yours, because you held at the record date); bonus → sell the original shares and put the bonus shares on the pending-exits list; split → put the whole exit on the pending-exits list until the new shares (often under a new ISIN) are credited. Use the same price factor for sell limits as for buys. Confirm what your broker allows and apply the same rule in paper.
21. Drop or hold any order for a stock that is TRADE_BLOCKED, staircase-tagged, outside your series filter, or not tradeable on D+1.
22. Check cash: total buys must not exceed available cash after sells (decide whether sell proceeds on D+1 can fund buys on D+1; mirror whatever the backtest assumed).
23. Write the order file for D+1, raw prices only, with a reason per order.

Stage 7 — Close the day

24. Run end-of-run checks: ledger cash ⩾ 0, no negative positions, every order has a reason, every fill has a cost row, equity row exists.
25. Archive inputs, outputs and the log. Append a one-line daily summary (trades, fills, blocked orders, equity, drawdown).

Morning of D+1 (optional, 5 minutes)

- Check for overnight corporate action announcements or exchange circulars that affect D+1 orders (ex-date changes, surveillance actions such as ASM/GSM moves, suspensions).
- Paper orders are not changed after the evening run. If something is wrong, log it and let the evening reconciliation show the effect. This keeps paper honest.

Corporate action handling in paper and live

In the backtest the adjusted series silently did this work; in paper you do it in the ledger, and in live the depository does part of it and you reconcile. Missed corporate actions are the single most common reason paper and backtest curves drift apart.

Action	What the adjusted series did	Paper ledger action (on ex-date)	Live: what actually happens	Live: what you must do
Split	Divided past prices by the ratio and multiplied past volume by it	Quantity × ratio; average cost ÷ ratio; stops/targets ÷ ratio	Depository credits new shares, usually within a few days of the record date	Adjust your ledger on ex-date; until shares appear in the broker holdings, treat the difference as “in transit”
Bonus	Multiplied past prices by b/(a+b) and past volume by (a+b)/b	Same as split with the bonus ratio	Bonus shares are credited after the record date, often taking 1–2 weeks and may not be sellable immediately	Do not place sell orders for bonus shares until they are visible as sellable in the broker holdings
Dividend	Scaled past prices down by the dividend yield	Receivable on ex-date on the shares held at the previous close, even if sold on the ex-date; cash credited on payment date (net of any TDS you choose to model)	Paid to your linked bank account, not the trading account	Record it as “strategy cash held outside broker”; decide whether you transfer it back in

Action	What the adjusted series did	Paper ledger action (on ex-date)	Live: what actually happens	Live: what you must do
Rights	Adjusted by theoretical ex-rights price	Log entitlement; apply pre-written rule	Rights entitlements (REs) are credited to demat and can be traded or applied for	Pick one rule and follow it every time; most systematic strategies let REs lapse or sell them, and document the impact
Merger / demerger	Varies by data vendor; check carefully	Close old position, open new one(s) at the cost split announced by the company	New shares credited; old symbol may be suspended before listing of the new one	Handle manually; freeze trading in both symbols until the new one is listed and data is clean
Symbol change	None (same ISIN)	No action if keyed by ISIN	Same ISIN, new symbol	Update the symbol map
Suspension / delisting	Series ends	Position cannot be sold; mark at last price or a haircut	Order rejected	Exception list; manual decision

Daily corporate action checks (both paper and live):

- [ ] Any held stock going ex tomorrow? Pre-compute the factor and log it.
- [ ] Any held stock going ex today? Ledger adjusted before booking today's fills, and value-neutral check passed.
- [ ] Any pending order for a stock going ex on its execution day? Reference price, quantity and limit adjusted; sells follow the ex-date sell rule; pending exits checked.
- [ ] Any dividend payment date today? Cash credited (paper) or bank credit matched (live).

- [ ] Any announced action not yet in the master? Add it before the evening signal run.

Unadjusted circuit trap. On a split, bonus or rights ex-date the exchange adjusts the base price used for that day's price band; ordinary dividends generally do not change the base price (verify the current rule). If your flags compare raw D close with raw D−1 close on an ex-date, they will see a false lower circuit. Apply the D ex-date factor to the previous close before computing the band, or skip circuit detection on ex-dates.

Worked example. Two Evenings Around an Ex-Date follows nine stocks (a split, a dividend and a bonus, each held, bought and sold) through the evening before the ex-date and the evening of it, with every quantity, limit, fill and mark-to-market worked out.

Before going live: one-time setup

Go live only after Parallel run 1 has passed and every item below is in place; most first-week live failures are operational, not strategic.

Broker and account

1. Choose one broker with a stable order API and AMO support. Use a trading and demat account dedicated to this strategy; personal holdings or other strategies in the same account make daily reconciliation unreliable. Confirm in writing (support ticket or documentation): the AMO acceptance window, whether market AMOs are allowed, any market-protection or price-buffer rules, and how AMOs behave on ex-dates.
2. Complete eDIS / DDPI authorisation so sell orders do not stall waiting for a TPIN step every morning.
3. Understand fund blocking: AMO buys block funds at placement, based on the limit price (or a buffer for market orders). Keep a cash buffer of a few percent above planned buys.
4. Check the SEBI retail algo framework applicable to your setup: API access requirements (e.g. static IP registration, order tagging) and the order-rate threshold above which an algo must be registered. An EOD strategy placing a few dozen orders a day is usually well below that threshold, but confirm with your broker.
5. Settlement: India is on T+1 settlement. Shares bought on D are credited on D+1. An EOD strategy rarely sells the next morning, but if it can, decide whether to allow it (short-delivery risk) or block it.

Order construction rules (write these down)

6. Order type: limit orders with a buffer are recommended. Example: buy limit = reference price × (1 + 2%), sell limit = reference price × (1 − 2%), then capped inside the D+1 price band and rounded to the tick size in force on that date (NSE has revised tick sizes by price slab in recent years, so keep a dated tick-size table rather than a constant ₹0.05, and verify the current slabs). Reference price = raw close of D, × ex-date factor if D+1 is an ex-date.
7. Band check: compute D+1 band = raw base price ± band%, tick-rounded. A limit outside the band is rejected by the exchange. Stocks in F&O have no fixed band but have operating ranges; use your buffer only.
8. Product type: delivery (CNC or the broker's equivalent). Never intraday/MIS by accident.
9. Maximum order value and quantity per stock, and a maximum total order value per day. The order script refuses to send anything above these.
10. Freeze quantities and lot sizes do not apply to cash equities in the same way as F&O, but very large orders in illiquid names should be split or capped by your volume rule.

Safety controls

11. Dry-run mode: the live order script can run without sending orders, printing exactly what it would send. Run it in dry-run for at least a week during Parallel run 2's start.
12. Kill switch: one command that cancels all open orders and stops the next scheduled run.
13. Pre-send checks: order count, total value and largest single order compared with the previous 20 days' typical values; anything unusual needs manual confirmation.
14. Idempotency: each order carries a client tag built from date + ISIN + side, so a re-run cannot place the same order twice.
15. Alerts: the job sends you a message (email, Telegram, etc.) on start, success, failure and any rejection.

Records and tax

16. Keep every contract note and the broker's tradebook download; these are the legal record and the source of truth for costs.
17. Discuss treatment of gains (short-term vs long-term capital gains, or business income for frequent trading) with a chartered accountant before you start, because it affects what you need to record. This guide is not tax advice.

Daily routine: Live EOD trading with After Market Orders

Live trading splits the paper run into three windows — evening of D (decide and place AMOs), morning of D+1 (watch execution), and after the open of D+1 (reconcile to the broker) — and the broker, not your code, is now the source of truth for positions.

Window A — Evening of D (after bhavcopy, before the AMO window closes)

1. Run Stages 1, 4 and 5 of the paper routine exactly as written: data in and checked, mark to market, rebuild adjusted series, flags, strategy signals.
2. **Reconcile first, then decide.** Pull broker holdings, positions, funds and the day's tradebook. Your live ledger must match the broker before you compute new orders. If it doesn't, stop and fix the ledger (see Reconciliation).
3. Apply corporate actions going ex on D to the live ledger (on quantities held at the previous close, before booking today's tradebook), and mark any shares "in transit" (bonus/split not yet credited).
4. Compute target vs actual positions using **broker quantities**, not intended quantities. Yesterday's unfilled orders are now simply a gap between target and actual; decide by rule whether to re-place them. Check the pending-exits list and place sells for any shares that have become sellable.
5. Build orders with the rules from the pre-live setup: reference price (× D+1 ex-date factor if any), buffered limit, capped inside the D+1 band, tick-rounded, delivery product, client tag.
6. Run pre-send checks: cash ≥ blocked amount + buffer; sell quantity ≤ sellable holdings (excluding in-transit and unsettled shares); order count and value within limits; no TRADE_BLOCKED or staircase-tagged stock; no stock under trading suspension.
7. Send AMOs. Save the broker's order IDs against your client tags.
8. Read back the order book. Every intended order must show as AMO-pending (or equivalent) at the broker. Any rejection at placement → fix and resend now, or log as skipped.
9. Run the paper engine on the same signals for the same day (Parallel run 2), writing to the paper ledger.
10. Archive everything and send yourself the evening summary.

Window B — Morning of D+1 (around 8:45–9:20)

11. Before 9:00: check for overnight exchange circulars, surveillance changes (ASM/GSM), suspensions or corporate action changes affecting today's orders. Cancel affected AMOs by rule, not by feel.
12. Around 9:00: AMOs are released to the exchange. For stocks in the pre-open call auction, orders join it (order entry roughly 9:00–9:08, matching right after, normal market from 9:15). Check the order book: status should change from AMO-pending to open or executed.
13. Rejections at release (band breached after an unexpected base-price change, insufficient funds, surveillance restriction): log the reason code. Do not chase with market orders unless your written rule says so.
14. Around 9:15–9:20: pre-open matches are visible. For stocks not in pre-open, fills start at 9:15 in continuous trading.

Window C — After the open of D+1 (e.g. 9:30, and again after 15:30)

15. Around 9:30: pull order book and tradebook. For each order: filled quantity, average price, pending quantity, rejection reason.
16. Apply your rule for unfilled limit orders: leave until close, cancel at a fixed time, or modify once. Whatever you choose, the paper engine must model the same rule.
17. After 15:30: pull the final tradebook. Cancel nothing (day orders expire automatically), but confirm nothing remains open.
18. Update the live ledger from the tradebook: quantity, average fill price, and order status. Costs are provisional until the contract note arrives.
19. When the contract note arrives (usually the same evening): replace provisional costs with actual ones, line by line.
20. Record per fill: decision price (raw close of D), benchmark (official D+1 open from bhavcopy), actual average fill. These three numbers drive all slippage analysis.
21. Then the D+1 evening run begins (Window A again for the next day).

Parallel run 1: Backtest replay vs Paper EOD

Start it on the first day of paper trading and run it for at least 3 months; it passes when the daily paper signals match a backtest replay of the same dates 100%, and every equity difference is explained by a known modelling difference.

What it is. Each day you run Paper EOD as normal (causal, one day at a time). Separately, you re-run the frozen backtest engine over the paper period using the latest back-adjusted data, the same universe, the same fill rules and the same cost model. The two should produce the same signals and almost the same equity curve. If they don't, either the daily pipeline has a bug or the backtest had hidden look-ahead.

When to start and stop

- Start: day 1 of paper trading. Never start paper trading without it.
- Minimum length: whichever is longer of 3 months, 50 completed round-trip trades, or the period needed to see these events at least once: a corporate action on a held stock, a dividend, an NSE holiday, a circuit-blocked order, a TRADE_BLOCKED day, a month end.
- Restart from zero if the strategy, config or flags library version changes.

Daily tasks (about 15 minutes after the evening run)

1. Run the backtest replay from the paper start date to D.
2. Compare D's signals: paper signals file vs replay signals for D. Must be identical (same stocks, same direction, same ranks or weights).
3. Compare D's orders and fills: same stocks, same quantities (allowing rounding), same blocked/unfilled outcomes.
4. Compare equity: paper equity vs replay equity, cumulative and daily difference.
5. Log every difference with a cause code: DATA (bhavcopy vs vendor value), CA (corporate action handled differently), ROUND (share rounding), COST, FILL_RULE, LOOKAHEAD, BUG.
6. Any signal mismatch = stop paper trading new entries until explained. Signal mismatches never "average out".

Weekly tasks

- Review the difference log; every entry must have a cause and, for BUG or LOOKAHEAD, a fix and a test.
- Recompute the replay over the entire paper period (not just appending), since back-adjustment rescales history.

What it typically catches

- **Price-level look-ahead in the backtest.** Back-adjusted prices before a split are scaled down using a split that hadn't happened yet. Any rule using a price level — a "price > ₹20" filter, a rupee ATR, a round-number breakout, a circuit band in rupees, tick size —

behaves differently on back-adjusted vs as-of-D data. Paper (causal) is right; the backtest needs fixing.

- **Dividend adjustment differences.** If the backtest used total-return adjustment but paper credits dividends on payment date, equity differs by timing only; that is acceptable if logged.
- **Data differences.** Your stitched historical data (multiple vendors, NSE/BSE) vs the official bhavcopy. Small close-price differences can flip a signal at a threshold. Volume left unadjusted in some vendor months shows up as flag and liquidity differences around split and bonus dates.
- **Batch vs per-bar disagreement.** Your owner rule — batch and per-bar flags must agree — is tested here for free every day.

Exit criteria (all must hold)

- [ ] 100% signal match over the last 40 trading days.
- [ ] Cumulative equity difference below a pre-set tolerance (e.g. 0.25% of capital) and fully explained.
- [ ] Every corporate action on a held stock processed correctly at least once.
- [ ] No unresolved BUG or LOOKAHEAD entries.
- [ ] Paper performance statistics (hit rate, average trade, turnover, cost drag) inside the range you expected from the backtest's own variability, not just the backtest's average.

Parallel run 2: Paper EOD vs Live EOD

Start it only after Parallel run 1 has passed, scale live capital up in stages over 3–6 months, and keep the paper engine running permanently as a shadow even after you are fully live.

What it is. The same signals each evening feed two books: the paper ledger (fills from the bhavcopy open plus your slippage model) and the live account (real AMOs, real fills). Paper shows what the strategy should have earned; live shows what the market allowed. The gap is your true implementation cost, and it is the number your backtest cost model must eventually match.

Two comparison views — keep both

- **Independent books.** Paper and live each keep their own positions. Over weeks this shows total drift, including path effects (an unfilled buy in live means a different portfolio for weeks).

- **Per-order execution.** For each live order, compare the live fill with what paper assumed for the same stock on the same day. This isolates slippage and fill-rate effects from path effects.

Compare in percentage returns, or run the paper book at the same capital as the live book in each phase, so quantities are directly comparable. Start a fresh shadow paper book on live day 1, seeded with the live account's actual positions and cash, and re-seed it at each capital phase change. Keep the original Parallel run 1 paper book running separately; its months of earlier path would otherwise swamp the paper vs live comparison.

Capital ramp with gates

Phase	Live capital	Minimum length	Gate to move on
0. Dry run	₹0 (orders built, not sent)	1–2 weeks	Live order file = paper order file every day (same stocks, sides, quantities); no script failures
1. Pilot	~10% of intended	1–2 months, ≥ 30 orders	Fill rate and slippage within pre-set limits; zero unreconciled breaks; every rejection understood
2. Partial	~25–50%	1–2 months	Same as Phase 1 at larger size; slippage does not rise sharply with order size
3. Full	100%	Ongoing	Monthly review keeps passing; paper shadow continues

Daily tasks (both books, every trading day)

1. Evening: confirm both books used the same signals file (same checksum).
2. Evening: confirm live orders and paper orders are identical in intent; differences allowed only for documented reasons (live had an unfilled order yesterday, cash differs, shares in transit).
3. After D+1 fills: for every order record live status, live average price, D+1 official open, paper fill price.
4. Compute and log: fill rate (live filled qty ÷ ordered qty), slippage vs open in bps per order, rejection count by reason.

5. Compute equity tracking difference (live return − paper return) for the day and cumulative, and split it into: slippage, unfilled orders, costs (actual vs modelled), corporate action timing, other.
6. Any "other" amount above a small threshold (e.g. 5 bps of capital on the day) gets investigated the next morning.

Weekly tasks

- Slippage by liquidity bucket (e.g. by 20-day median traded value) and by pre-open vs non-pre-open stocks.
- Fill rate by bucket; list of every unfilled order with the reason.
- Compare actual total costs from contract notes with the paper cost model.

Stop or roll back if any of these happen

- Live drawdown exceeds 1.5× the worst drawdown the backtest showed at the same horizon.
- Average slippage exceeds 2× the modelled slippage for 20 trading days.
- Two or more reconciliation breaks you can't explain in a single week.
- Any order sent that the strategy did not intend (wrong side, wrong quantity, duplicate).

Rolling back means dropping one phase of capital (or to dry run), not abandoning the strategy; fix, then re-pass that phase's gate.

Feed it back. After Phase 2, replace the backtest's assumed costs and slippage with the measured ones by liquidity bucket and re-run the backtest. If the strategy is no longer attractive with real costs, that is the most valuable finding of the whole process.

Reconciliation and slippage metrics

Reconcile three things every live day — positions, cash and orders — and measure every fill against the official open; a break left open for even one day contaminates every later signal.

Daily reconciliation (live)

Check	Your ledger	Broker source	Tolerance	If it breaks
Holdings quantity per ISIN	Live positions	Holdings + today's positions	Exact (in-transit shares listed separately)	Stop new orders for that stock; find the missing trade or corporate action
Average cost per ISIN	Ledger cost basis	Holdings average price	Small differences OK (broker may include charges)	Log only; your ledger is the analytic record
Cash	Ledger cash	Funds / margin statement	Within ₹ of pending charges	Check contract note charges, dividends to bank, transfers
Orders	Intended orders file	Order book	Every intended order has a broker ID and final status	Missing = treat as not placed; duplicate = kill switch and investigate
Fills	Ledger fills	Tradebook	Exact quantity and price	Tradebook wins; correct the ledger
Costs	Provisional costs	Contract note	Exact	Contract note wins; update cost model if systematic

Slippage and implementation shortfall

For each fill, with side s = +1 for buys and −1 for sells:

```
\text{Execution slippage (bps)} = s \cdot \frac{P_{\text{fill}} - P_{\text{open},T+1}}{P_{\text{open},T+1}} \cdot 10{,}000
```

Positive means you paid more (buy) or received less (sell) than the official open. Use the raw official open from the T+1 bhavcopy, and the raw close of T multiplied by any T+1 ex-date factor for the decision price.

The full gap between the decision and the result splits into three parts:

- **Overnight gap** = s × (open of T+1 − decision price). The backtest already includes this; it is not a cost of trading live.
- **Execution slippage** = s × (fill − open of T+1). The live cost the backtest must model.
- **Opportunity cost of unfilled quantity** = unfilled shares × the move you missed (measure over the strategy's normal holding period, not just one day).

Metrics to track (daily values, weekly and monthly summaries)

- Fill rate by quantity and by order count.
- Mean and median execution slippage in bps, overall and by liquidity bucket.
- Share of orders filled in the pre-open auction vs continuous market.
- Rejection count by reason.
- Cost drag: actual costs ÷ traded value, vs modelled.
- Tracking difference: live return − paper return, daily and cumulative, with its attribution.

Exception playbook

Decide the response to every exception in advance and apply it the same way in paper and live; improvising on the day is where discretion leaks into a systematic strategy.

Situation	Paper response	Live response
Bhavcopy late or missing	Wait; do not run on vendor data unless that is the written fallback	Same; if past the AMO cut-off, place no new orders that day and log it
Bhavcopy fails validation	Stop the run; fix or re-download	Same; no AMOs from bad data
Unexpected holiday or special session (e.g. Muhurat trading)	Follow the calendar; Muhurat session normally ignored by EOD strategies	Same; never place AMOs into a special session by accident
Stock opens upper-circuit locked (buy)	Mark unfilled, reason UC_LOCK	Order stays pending in queue; apply your cancel-time rule

Situation	Paper response	Live response
Stock opens lower-circuit locked (sell)	Mark unfilled, reason LC_LOCK; retry next day by rule	Same; a locked stock you hold is a risk item — log it daily until exited
Limit order not filled (price ran away)	Model with your fill rule (e.g. unfilled if open beyond limit)	Leave or cancel by rule; never chase manually
Order rejected: outside price band	Should not happen in paper; if your check would have rejected it, model as unfilled	Fix the band calculation; usually caused by an ex-date factor or stale base price
Order rejected: funds	n/a	Check blocked funds and buffer; reduce the cash buffer rule only after investigation
Order rejected: surveillance (ASM/GSM, trade-for-trade, suspension)	Model as unfilled	Add the stock to an exclusion list; check the series filter
Ex-date on execution day	Adjust reference price and quantity	Same; verify broker accepted the AMO with the adjusted price
Split/bonus shares not yet credited	Model a sellable-from date (your broker's typical credit lag); keep the exit on the pending-exits list until then	Mark in transit; block sells on those shares until credited (bonus: original shares stay sellable)
Market-wide circuit breaker (MWCB) halt	Follow your flags (MWCB_DAY block if configured)	Halts happen during the session; AMOs at the open are unaffected unless the halt triggers early; follow the same flag rule
Broker API or login down at evening	Not applicable	Retry; if still down, place the AMOs manually from the order file or skip the day by written rule
Broker down at open	Not applicable	Orders are already at the exchange; reconcile as soon as access returns

Situation	Paper response	Live response
Your machine or script failed	Re-run with the same inputs; outputs must match	Same; never re-send orders without checking the order book (idempotent client tags)
Duplicate or wrong order sent	Not applicable	Kill switch; cancel; reverse only by rule; full post-mortem
Data correction published later	Re-run affected days in a sandbox; log the difference; do not rewrite history	Same; live fills are final whatever later data says
Strategy produces an unusual number of orders	Log and continue (paper is the test)	Manual confirmation required by the pre-send check

Operating governance: rules that must be written down before going live

The review of this guide found these topics missing; each is a rule you write once, apply identically in paper and live, and change only through the change process in this section.

Exits and stops must match the backtest

- If the backtest exits on a close-based rule (close below stop → sell next open), live does exactly that with an AMO. No intraday stop orders.
- If the backtest assumed an intraday stop filled at the stop price, live needs a resting order (for example a broker GTT order). The backtest must then model gaps: a stock that opens below the stop fills at the open, not at the stop. Re-run the backtest with that rule before going live.
- Never add live stops the backtest did not have. They change the strategy.

Rebalance schedule and non-rebalance days

- Write down when the strategy trades: every day, weekly (which weekday, and what happens if it is a holiday), or monthly (which trading day).

- On non-rebalance days the whole evening routine still runs: data checks, fills, corporate actions, mark-to-market, reconciliation, risk cards. Only order generation is skipped.

Unfilled order retry rule (default)

- Default: an unfilled entry is re-evaluated by the next evening's signal and re-placed only if the signal still holds. An unfilled exit is re-placed every day until filled. Exits deferred by a split or bonus credit go on a pending-exits list with a sellable-from date (paper: your broker's typical credit lag; during Parallel run 2: the actual live credit date) and are placed as soon as the shares are sellable.
- Paper models the same rule. Log every retry with the original order's tag.

Integer shares and high-priced stocks

- Small capital plus high share prices create rounding error: a ₹50,000 allocation buys zero shares of a ₹1,00,000 stock.
- Rule: skip a stock if one share exceeds e.g. 1.5× its target allocation, and set a minimum capital for the strategy so that rounding error stays below e.g. 2% of target weights on average. Apply the same skip rule in the backtest.

Benchmark and performance reporting

- Compare against a total return index (e.g. Nifty 50 TRI or Nifty 500 TRI, matching your universe), not the price index. Your returns include dividends, so the benchmark must too.
- Report time-weighted returns, so deposits and withdrawals do not distort performance.
- Report gross, after costs, and an estimated after-tax figure. Holding period decides short-term vs long-term capital gains, so a high-turnover strategy can look very different after tax; confirm current rates with your chartered accountant.

Change management while live

- No code, config or data-source change goes straight into live.
- Process: change → unit tests and verify script → re-run full backtest → run the new version as a second shadow paper book beside the current one for at least 20 trading days → compare signals and results → switch on a chosen date → record the new version and checksum.

- Exception: urgent fixes for data errors or broker changes, which are logged as such and reviewed the next weekend.

Manual override register

- Any human decision that changes what the strategy would have done (a news veto, a skipped order, a manual exit) is logged: date, stock, rule or reason, who, expected effect.
- Every override is applied to the shadow paper book too, and its effect is measured monthly. A pattern of overrides is a sign the strategy, not the operator, needs changing.

Security of credentials

- API keys, passwords and TOTP secrets are never stored in code, config files, logs or chat. Use the Windows Credential Manager or an encrypted vault.
- Read your broker's terms on automated login and two-factor authentication; some brokers and SEBI rules require a manual login step each day. Plan the evening routine around it.
- Use broker API keys restricted to what the strategy needs, and rotate them on a schedule.

Business continuity

- Written runbook: every step of the evening and morning routine, with the exact PowerShell commands, so the routine can be run by someone else or by you from another machine.
- A second machine (or cloud machine) with the same code, tested monthly.
- Default if the routine cannot run (illness, travel, outage): place no new orders, hold existing positions, and run the full routine as soon as possible. Write down who decides on exits if you are unavailable for several days.

Special corporate events

- Buybacks (tender route), open offers and delisting offers: default is not to tender; the position is treated like any other. Write down if you ever will tender, and model it in paper.
- Rights entitlements: they appear as a separate ISIN in holdings. Add them to the reconciliation as a known exception and apply the rights rule from the corporate actions section.

Strategy retirement criteria

- Decide in advance what ends the strategy, for example: rolling 12-month return below the benchmark by more than the backtest's worst 12-month underperformance, or drawdown beyond the stop condition after a full roll-back cycle.
- Retirement means stopping new entries and exiting by the strategy's normal exit rules, not a panic sale.

Weekly, monthly and quarterly tasks

The daily routine keeps the books correct; these periodic reviews decide whether the strategy is still working and whether to move to the next stage.

Frequency	Task	Stage
Weekly	Review the difference log (Parallel run 1) or tracking attribution (Parallel run 2)	Paper, Live
Weekly	Slippage and fill-rate summary by liquidity bucket	Live
Weekly	Re-run the full backtest replay over the whole paper period	Paper
Weekly	Check upcoming corporate actions for all held stocks for the next 2 weeks	Paper, Live
Weekly	Back up the archive (raw files, ledgers, logs) to a second location	All
Monthly	Performance report: return, drawdown, turnover, cost drag, hit rate vs backtest expectations	Paper, Live
Monthly	Compare live costs from contract notes with the cost model; update rates in config if they changed	Live
Monthly	Reconcile the live ledger with the broker's P&L / tax statement	Live
Monthly	Review exclusions: surveillance lists, staircase/chronic tags, suspended stocks	Paper, Live
Monthly	Gate review: decide whether to move to the next capital phase, stay, or roll back	Live

Frequency	Task	Stage
Quarterly	Refresh the universe and F&O membership list by the same rule as the backtest	Paper, Live
Quarterly	Update the MWCB index-point thresholds if you compute them from quarter-end values	Paper, Live
Quarterly	Re-run the backtest with measured costs and slippage; confirm the strategy still clears your hurdle	Live
Yearly	Load the next year's NSE holiday calendar	All
Yearly	Tax-year close: capital gains report, dividend statement, reconciliation with your accountant	Live
Yearly	Review fee and tax rates (STT, stamp duty, exchange charges, GST) for changes from the Union Budget or SEBI/exchange circulars	All

Records and folder layout

Keep raw inputs untouched, write one dated folder per trading day, and never overwrite a past day's signals, orders or fills; that is what makes any day reproducible months later.

A suggested layout (the root path E:\Trading is only an example):

```
E:\Trading\
  config\            strategy config, cost rates, fill rules, risk limits
(versioned)
  code\              frozen strategy + flags library (one folder per version)
  reference\         corporate_actions_master.csv, isin_symbol_map.csv,
                     nse_holidays_2026.csv, fo_membership.csv,
series_filter.csv
  raw\bhavcopy\      one file per day, exactly as downloaded
  raw\index\         Nifty 50 / other index files per day
  raw\broker\        tradebook, order book, holdings, funds, contract notes
per day
  daily\2026-10-06\  signals.csv, flags.csv, orders_paper.csv,
orders_live.csv,
                     fills_paper.csv, fills_live.csv, recon.csv, run.log,
checksums.txt
  ledger\paper\      positions, cash, fills, costs, ca_events, equity
(append-only)
  ledger\live\       same tables as paper
  parallel\run1\     replay outputs, difference log
  parallel\run2\     slippage log, tracking attribution, phase gate reviews
  reports\           weekly and monthly reports
```

Rules that keep records trustworthy

- Every daily folder includes the code version and config checksum used.
- Ledgers are append-only. Corrections are new rows with a reason, never edits of old rows.
- Adjusted price series are not stored as records; they are rebuilt from raw files plus the corporate actions master whenever needed.
- Keep broker contract notes for as long as your tax rules require (ask your accountant); keep everything else at least as long as you run the strategy.

One-page daily checklists

Print or copy these; each line should take seconds to tick once the pipeline is automated, and an unticked line means the day is not finished.

Paper EOD — every trading evening

- [ ] Trading day confirmed; bhavcopy and index files downloaded, archived, validated

- [ ] Corporate actions master updated with new announcements
- [ ] Ex-date adjustments applied to shares held at yesterday's close (before fills); value-neutral check passed
- [ ] Yesterday's paper orders filled or marked unfilled with reason codes
- [ ] Positions marked to market at raw close; equity row written
- [ ] Adjusted price and volume series rebuilt (ex-date ⩽ today); flags run on adjusted volume; signals saved
- [ ] Orders for tomorrow built in raw prices (ex-date factor applied where needed)
- [ ] End-of-run checks passed; log archived; daily summary sent

Parallel run 1 — every trading evening during paper

- [ ] Backtest replay run to today
- [ ] Signals match 100%
- [ ] Orders, fills and equity differences logged with cause codes
- [ ] Any signal mismatch: new paper entries paused until explained

Live EOD — Window A, evening of D

- [ ] Paper checklist stages done (data, MTM, signals)
- [ ] Broker holdings, funds, tradebook pulled; ledger reconciled with no open breaks
- [ ] Contract note costs posted for today's fills
- [ ] Orders built from broker quantities; limits buffered, inside band, tick-rounded
- [ ] Pre-send checks passed (cash, sellable quantity, limits, blocked stocks)
- [ ] AMOs sent; order book read back; every order has a broker ID
- [ ] Paper shadow run on the same signals file

Live EOD — Window B, morning of D+1

- [ ] Overnight circulars, surveillance changes and corporate action changes checked before 9:00
- [ ] AMOs released to exchange (status changed from AMO-pending)
- [ ] Rejections logged with reasons

Live EOD — Window C, after the open of D+1

- [ ] Fills pulled around 9:30; unfilled-order rule applied

- [ ] Final tradebook pulled after 15:30; nothing left open
- [ ] Per-fill decision price, official open and fill price recorded

Parallel run 2 — every trading day during the capital ramp

- [ ] Same signals file checksum in paper and live
- [ ] Live vs paper orders compared; differences have documented reasons
- [ ] Fill rate, slippage (bps) and rejections logged
- [ ] Tracking difference computed and attributed; “other” above threshold flagged for investigation
- [ ] Stop / roll-back conditions checked

Evening checklist cards (detailed)

Work these 14 cards top to bottom every trading evening, after the bhavcopy is published and before orders are sent; a card passes only when every row passes, and a failed row is handled by its “If it fails” column before moving on.

The one-page checklists above are the quick daily tick-list; these cards are the full definition of each check. The **Applies** column shows P (paper), L (live) or P/L (both). Thresholds marked “e.g.” are starting values: set your own once you have 2–3 months of your own daily data, and keep them in config so paper and live use the same numbers.

Order of work: Cards 1–6 check inputs (can I trust today’s data and market state?). Cards 7–9 check what the strategy did and will do. Cards 10–13 check the portfolio as a whole. Card 14 closes the day. Send AMOs (row 8.12) only after every other row of Cards 1–13 has passed.

Card 1 — Run gate and calendar

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
1.1	Trading day	Today is a trading day in the NSE calendar file	Log “holiday”, stop the run	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
1.2	Special session	Not a special session (Muhurat, Saturday budget session), or the written rule for it is applied	Apply the rule; never trade it by accident	P/L
1.3	Tomorrow is a trading day	Next trading day identified from the calendar (T+1 is never assumed to be the next calendar day)	Fix the calendar before building orders	P/L
1.4	Code and config version	Strategy, flags library and config checksums equal the frozen version	Stop; an intended change restarts Parallel run 1	P/L
1.5	Previous day closed	Yesterday's daily folder has all outputs and a sign-off (Card 14)	Finish or repair yesterday first	P/L
1.6	System clock	Machine time is IST and synced	Fix before any timestamped step	P/L
1.7	Disk and backup	Free space above your minimum; last backup within 7 days	Free space / run backup	P/L
1.8	Broker access	Login and API session valid; token will not expire before the AMO window closes	Re-login now; never discover this at 8:55 AM	L

Card 2 — Bhavcopy data quality

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
2.1	File present	Today's CM bhavcopy downloaded, parsed, untouched copy archived with checksum	Retry; use the written fallback only if one exists, else no new orders today	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
2.2	Correct date	Trade date inside the file = today	Wrong file: stop	P/L
2.3	Row count	Within e.g. ±5% of the 20-day median	Investigate partial file	P/L
2.4	Duplicates	No duplicate ISIN + series rows	Stop; fix parser	P/L
2.5	OHLC integrity	Low ⩽ Open, Close ⩽ High; all prices > 0; volume ⩾ 0	Exclude that stock today, log	P/L
2.6	Previous close continuity	File's previous close = your stored close of yesterday for e.g. ⩾ 99% of stocks; every mismatch explained by an ex-date	Unexplained mismatch: check corporate actions and data source	P/L
2.7	Extreme moves	Every move beyond its price band, or beyond e.g. 20%, is explained by F&O status (no band), an ex-date, a band revision or a relisting	Unexplained: exclude the stock from new orders, investigate	P/L
2.8	Coverage	Every held stock and every universe stock is present, or its absence is explained (suspension, holiday-specific series)	Held stock missing: mark at last price, flag in Card 10	P/L
2.9	No-trade days	Held and candidate stocks show trades today; zero-volume names listed	Flag as illiquid; feeds Cards 8 and 12	P/L
2.10	Series	Series of each held/universe stock unchanged (EQ → BE/BZ moves listed)	Apply series filter; block new buys	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
2.11	Vendor cross-check	Closes for all held stocks + e.g. 50 random stocks match broker EOD data within one tick	Investigate before trusting today's data	P/L
2.12	Index file	Nifty 50 (and other used indices) OHLC present for today, previous close continuous	Fix before MWCB and beta checks	P/L

Card 3 — Reference data and corporate actions

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
3.1	Announcements loaded	Today's corporate action announcements added to the master (type, ratio/amount, ex-date, record date)	Load before the signal run	P/L
3.2	Ex-date today, held stocks	Quantity held at the previous close × k; cost and stops ÷ k; dividend receivable on that quantity; done before booking today's fills (Card 9); value-neutral check passed	Fix ledger; stop orders for that stock	P/L
3.3	Ex-date tomorrow	Price factor and k saved with tonight's quantities in exdate_<D+1>.csv; holdings converted to tomorrow's share terms; order prices, quantities and limits adjusted; sells follow the ex-date sell rule (dividend: sell; bonus: originals only; split: pending exit)	Adjust or drop the order	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
3.4	Dividends	Today's payment-date receivables credited (P); bank credits matched to the strategy's outside-broker cash ledger (L)	Chase missing credit; log	P/L
3.5	Shares in transit	Bonus/split shares not yet credited are listed and excluded from sellable quantity	Update in-transit list	L
3.6	Adjusted series rebuilt	Built only from ex-dates ⩽ today; spot check: for one stock with a recent action, adjusted/raw ratio before ex-date = the factor	Fix before signals	P/L
3.7	Symbol / ISIN map	No unmapped symbol changes; no ISIN appears under two symbols	Update map	P/L
3.8	Listings and delistings	New listings and delistings applied to the universe by the backtest's rule (e.g. minimum listing age)	Update universe file	P/L
3.9	F&O membership	Current list loaded; additions/exits applied from their effective date (affects price band)	Update before Card 8 band checks	P/L
3.10	Volume series adjusted	Past traded and deliverable quantity multiplied by the share-count ratio k for every split, bonus or consolidation with ex-date ⩽ today; turnover identity holds on a pre-ex-date day (adjusted price × adjusted volume = raw turnover)	Fix before signals, flags and liquidity checks	P/L

Card 4 — NSE level and circulars

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
4.1	Exchange circulars	Today's NSE circulars (Capital Market, Surveillance, Listing, Investor Services) read; any affecting holdings, tomorrow's orders or trading hours logged with an action	Apply the action before building orders	P/L
4.2	ASM / GSM / ESM lists	No held or candidate stock newly added or moved to a higher stage; any change logged	Block new buys by rule; for higher GSM stages note that trading may be restricted to certain days, so sells must be planned	P/L
4.3	Price band revisions	Band changes for held and candidate stocks applied to tomorrow's band calculation	Recompute band; re-check Card 8 limits	P/L
4.4	Trade-for-trade / series moves	No held or candidate stock moved to BE/BZ or similar without being reflected in the series filter	Update filter; block new buys	P/L
4.5	Suspensions and delisting notices	No suspension or delisting notice for held stocks	Exception list; plan exit before the effective date	P/L
4.6	F&O ban list	Noted for held stocks (cash delivery trading is not stopped by an F&O ban, but it signals crowded positioning)	Information only, unless your rule uses it	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
4.7	Market-wide state	Today's Nifty 50 move, MWCB status and flags (MWCB_DAY / halt) computed and logged	Apply MWCB block rule to tomorrow's orders	P/L
4.8	Timing changes	No announced change to tomorrow's session timings, pre-open, or a sudden holiday	Adjust schedule; re-check Card 1	P/L
4.9	Tick size and price-related rules	No tick-size change for held or candidate stocks	Update tick table before rounding limits	P/L
4.10	SEBI orders	No SEBI order (trading ban, investigation) naming a held or candidate company or its promoters	Block new buys; review held position by rule	P/L

Card 5 — Index constituents and weights

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
5.1	Constituent changes announced	Any NSE Indices announcement (periodic reviews are semi-annual; ad-hoc replacements happen after mergers, delistings, suspensions) logged with its effective date	Add to the pending-changes file	P/L
5.2	Point-in-time universe	Today's universe = constituents effective today, exactly as the backtest defined it (e.g. Nifty 500 members on that date)	Rebuild universe; no future members	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
5.3	Effective-date discipline	Announced additions and exclusions are not used before their effective date	Fix; this is look-ahead	P/L
5.4	Index weights computed	Weights from free-float market cap (close × shares × investable weight factor), capped per index rules where applicable; sum = 100%	Fix inputs (shares, IWF)	P/L
5.5	Weight cross-check	Monthly: top-10 weights within e.g. 0.25 percentage points of the official factsheet	Update shares / IWF data	P/L
5.6	Index return reconciliation	Your computed index return today vs official within e.g. 2 bps	Investigate constituent or weight error	P/L
5.7	Active weights	Portfolio stock and sector weights minus benchmark weights within your limits (feeds Card 10)	Flag; resize per rule	P/L
5.8	Rebalance-day effects	Stocks entering or leaving a major index tomorrow flagged; orders in them reviewed for abnormal volume and price on the effective date	Apply rule (skip, or allow with wider limit)	P/L

Card 6 — News and corporate announcements

This card exists to apply pre-written vetoes, never to add trades. Every veto must be applied identically in paper and live and logged with a reason code, or Parallel run 2 is contaminated.

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
6.1	Results and board meetings	Held and candidate stocks with results or a board meeting tomorrow are listed	Apply earnings rule (e.g. no new entries the day before results)	P/L
6.2	Corporate announcements	NSE announcements read for held and candidate stocks: outcomes of board meetings, fund raises, schemes of arrangement	Log; check Card 3 if it creates a corporate action	P/L
6.3	Promoter actions	No new promoter pledge invocation, large promoter sale or SAST disclosure of concern for held stocks	Apply rule; log	P/L
6.4	Credit events	No rating downgrade to default/below investment grade or payment default for held or candidate companies	Block new buys; review per rule	P/L
6.5	Governance red flags	No auditor or CFO resignation, forensic audit, fraud allegation or accounts qualification	Block new buys; review per rule	P/L
6.6	Legal and insolvency	No IBC / NCLT admission or major litigation outcome	Block new buys; review per rule	P/L
6.7	Special situations	Open offers, delisting offers, buybacks, mergers flagged (prices behave abnormally)	Exclude by rule	P/L
6.8	Macro event tomorrow	RBI policy, Union Budget, election results, major global events noted	Apply event rule if you have one; otherwise log only	P/L

Card 7 — Signals and flags

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
7.1	Signals file	Produced, named with today's date, checksum stored, never overwriting an earlier day	Re-run; investigate overwrite	P/L
7.2	Same signals for both books	Paper and live read the same signals file (same checksum)	Stop; fix pipeline	P/L
7.3	Signal count	Number of entries/exits within e.g. the 5th–95th percentile of the last 60 days	Investigate before ordering (data error or genuine regime)	P/L
7.4	Coverage	Share of universe with a valid signal within the normal range	Find missing data	P/L
7.5	Feature sanity	Zero NaN or infinite values in features used today; no feature outside its historical min–max by a wide margin	Fix data or exclude stock	P/L
7.6	Flags run	PRICE_BAND, CIRCUIT, MWCB, STAIRCASE, TRADE_BLOCKED computed as of today's close; counts within normal range	Investigate jumps	P/L
7.7	Batch vs per-bar	Today's flag row from the per-bar run equals the batch result	Stop; this is a bug	P/L
7.8	Implied turnover	Today's implied turnover within e.g. 2× the 60-day median	Manual confirmation before orders	P/L
7.9	Replay match	During Parallel run 1: today's signals equal the backtest replay's	Pause new entries until explained	P

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
7.10	Volume-based features and flags	Volume features, the staircase thin-volume baseline, the untag rule and the chronic flag run on split-adjusted volume; no volume spike or thin-volume signal on a split/bonus/consolidation ex-date that comes only from the share-count change	Re-run on adjusted volume; treat flags within 20 trading days after the action as unverified until fixed	P/L

Card 8 — Order-level checks (tomorrow's orders)

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
8.1	Order fields	Every order has ISIN, symbol, side, integer quantity > 0, delivery product, client tag	Fix; never send partial orders	P/L
8.2	Reference price	= today′s raw close × tomorrow′s ex-date factor (if any)	Recompute	P/L
8.3	Limit price	Buffered per rule, inside tomorrow′s price band, rounded to tick size	Recompute; rejected orders cost a day	P/L
8.4	Tradeability	Not TRADE_BLOCKED, staircase-tagged, under blocking surveillance, suspended, or outside the series filter	Drop order, reason code	P/L
8.5	Sell quantity	⩽ sellable holdings (excludes in-transit and unsettled shares)	Reduce to sellable; log	L
8.6	Size limits	Each order value ⩽ per-stock maximum; total ⩽ daily maximum	Scale down per rule or confirm manually	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
8.7	Liquidity cap	Order quantity ⩽ e.g. 1–2% of 20-day median split-adjusted volume (same share basis as the order)	Cap and log excess as unfilled-by-design	P/L
8.8	Cash cover	Total buy value (at limit) + buffer ⩽ available funds after any allowed sells	Reduce buys by priority rule	P/L
8.9	No duplicates	Client tags unique; no order for a stock already having an open order	Remove duplicate	P/L
8.10	Paper = live intent	Live and paper order files identical except documented differences	Explain or fix	P/L
8.11	Reason codes	Every order and every skipped order has a reason	Add before sending	P/L
8.12	AMO placed and read back	Every live order shows a broker order ID and AMO-pending status	Resend or log as skipped	L
8.13	Pending exits	Every exit deferred by a split or bonus credit has a sellable-from date; sells placed for shares that became sellable today; paper uses the same dates as live during Parallel run 2	Place the sell now, or chase the credit with the broker	P/L

Card 9 — Trade and fill-level checks (today's fills of yesterday's orders)

Work Card 9 before Card 8 on the night: today's fills change positions and cash, and tomorrow's orders must be built on the updated book.

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
9.1	Final status	Every order from yesterday has a final status: filled, partly filled, unfilled (with reason) or rejected (with reason)	Find status; never leave unknown	P/L
9.2	Fill source	Paper fills = today's raw open + modelled slippage; live fills = tradebook quantity and average price	Correct the ledger	P/L
9.3	Fill sanity	Every fill price within today's low–high range	Data or recording error: investigate	P/L
9.4	Slippage	Live fill vs official open within e.g. 50 bps per order; worse cases listed	Investigate stock, time, order type	L
9.5	No unintended trades	Tradebook contains nothing that is not in yesterday's order file	Kill switch and investigate immediately	L
9.6	Product type	All trades are delivery; nothing intraday that the broker could auto-square-off	Convert or close per broker process; investigate	L
9.7	Costs	Contract note charges match the cost model within e.g. ₹1 per trade or 2% of charges	Update model or query broker	L
9.8	Unfilled reasons	Every unfilled quantity coded (UC_LOCK, LC_LOCK, LIMIT_NOT_REACHED, REJECTED_BAND, REJECTED_FUNDS, SURVEILLANCE, VOLUME_CAP)	Code it	P/L
9.9	Paper vs live fills	Per order: live status and price vs paper assumption logged for Parallel run 2	Complete the log	L

Card 10 — Portfolio-level checks

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
10.1	Positions reconcile	Ledger quantity = broker holdings + today's positions for every ISIN (in-transit listed separately)	Stop new orders in that stock; find the break	L
10.2	Paper book integrity	No negative quantities; every position has cost basis and entry date	Fix ledger	P
10.3	Number of holdings	Within the strategy's min–max (e.g. 15–30)	Investigate signals or fills	P/L
10.4	Single-stock weight	Each position ⩽ e.g. 8% of equity at today's close	Trim per rule in tomorrow's orders	P/L
10.5	Sector weight	Each sector ⩽ e.g. 30% (using one fixed classification, e.g. NSE industry)	Trim per rule	P/L
10.6	Invested level	Invested % of equity within target band (e.g. 90–100%)	Check unfilled orders and cash	P/L
10.7	Liquidity of holdings	Days to exit each position at e.g. 20% of 20-day median split-adjusted volume ⩽ e.g. 3 days	Reduce size; tighten liquidity rule	P/L
10.8	Locked or stuck positions	Positions that are circuit-locked, suspended, in GSM higher stages or staircase-tagged listed with their value and days stuck	Track daily until resolved	P/L
10.9	Drawdown	Current drawdown from peak, compared with the backtest's distribution at the same horizon	Feeds Card 13 stop conditions	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
10.10	P&L attribution	Today's P&L split by stock; any single stock contributing more than e.g. 1% of equity has a known cause	Investigate (data, corporate action, real news)	P/L
10.11	Turnover	Month-to-date turnover vs expected from backtest	Investigate if far above expectation	P/L
10.12	Paper vs live tracking	Daily and cumulative tracking difference computed and attributed	Investigate "other" above threshold	L

Card 11 — Cash-level checks

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
11.1	Cash reconciles	Ledger cash = broker available funds ± known pending items (charges not yet debited, settlement timing)	Find the difference before ordering	L
11.2	Never negative	Paper cash ⩾ 0 after today's fills and costs	Bug in fill or cost logic	P
11.3	Tomorrow's buy cover	Buys at limit price + buffer ⩽ available funds	Reduce buys by priority rule (Card 8.8)	P/L
11.4	Sell-proceeds rule	Use of same-day sell proceeds for buys matches the backtest's assumption and the broker's actual rules	Align the rule; log	P/L
11.5	Charges posted	STT, exchange charges, SEBI fee, stamp duty, GST and DP charges posted from the contract note	Post before reconciling	L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
11.6	Dividends	Paper receivables credited on payment date; live bank credits matched and recorded as strategy cash outside the broker	Chase or correct	P/L
11.7	Idle cash	Uninvested cash within band (e.g. ⩽ 10% of equity) unless the strategy is deliberately in cash	Investigate unfilled orders or sizing	P/L
11.8	Capital flows	Any deposit or withdrawal logged with date so returns are computed time-weighted	Log it; never mix flows with P&L	L
11.9	Margin and blocks	No unexpected funds blocked (stale orders, pledges, other products)	Clear before tomorrow's AMOs	L

Card 12 — Portfolio sensitivity checks

These measure how much the portfolio could lose tomorrow under simple shocks. Compute them on tonight's positions plus tomorrow's intended orders.

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
12.1	Beta to Nifty 50	60-day portfolio beta within the strategy's normal range (e.g. 0.8–1.2)	Investigate drift; feeds 12.2	P/L
12.2	Index shock	Estimated loss for Nifty −5% and −10% (beta-based) below your limit, e.g. 7% and 13% of equity	Reduce gross or high-beta names per rule	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
12.3	Gap-down stress	Loss if every holding opens 10% lower, or at its lower band if the band is tighter	Note; compare to risk budget	P/L
12.4	Locked-exit stress	Loss if the 3 least liquid holdings hit lower circuit for 3 consecutive days and cannot be sold	Reduce illiquid exposure if above limit	P/L
12.5	Sector shock	Loss if the largest sector falls 10% while the rest are flat	Trim if above limit	P/L
12.6	Concentration of risk	Share of portfolio volatility from the top 5 positions ⩽ e.g. 40%	Rebalance per rule	P/L
12.7	Crowding	Average pairwise 60-day correlation of holdings vs its own history; unusually high = positions behave as one bet	Note; tighten sector or factor limits if persistent	P/L
12.8	Liquidity stress	Share of the portfolio that can be exited in one day at 10% of median split-adjusted volume ⩾ e.g. 80%	Reduce illiquid names	P/L
12.9	Event exposure	Share of portfolio with results, ex-dates, index changes or special situations tomorrow	Note; apply event rules	P/L
12.10	Factor tilts (weekly is enough)	Size, momentum, value and volatility exposures within the backtest's typical range	Investigate if far outside	P/L

Card 13 — Risk limits and stop conditions

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
13.1	Drawdown limit	Live drawdown < 1.5× the backtest's worst drawdown at the same horizon	Drop one capital phase (Parallel run 2 roll-back)	L
13.2	Daily loss limit	Today's loss < e.g. 3% of equity, or explained by a market-wide move (beta × index return)	Review before tomorrow's orders	P/L
13.3	Slippage limit	20-day average slippage < 2× the modelled slippage	Roll back one phase; revise cost model	L
13.4	Reconciliation breaks	Fewer than 2 unexplained breaks this week	Roll back one phase	L
13.5	Unintended orders	Zero this week	Kill switch; post-mortem before resuming	L
13.6	Rejection rate	Rejected orders < e.g. 5% of orders over 20 days	Fix band, tick or funds logic	L
13.7	Strategy health	Hit rate, average trade and turnover within the backtest's range of outcomes (monthly view)	Flag for monthly review	P/L
13.8	Kill switch	Tested in dry-run within the last 7 days	Test it	L

Card 14 — Close and sign-off

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
14.1	All cards complete	Cards 1–13 passed, or every failure has a logged action	Finish the open items	P/L

#	Check	Pass rule	If it fails	Applies
14.2	Exceptions log	Every exception today has date, stock, card and row, reason, action, owner	Complete the log	P/L
14.3	Daily folder complete	Inputs, signals, flags, orders, fills, reconciliation, log and checksums saved	Save missing files	P/L
14.4	Ledgers appended	Paper and live ledgers have today's rows; no past rows edited	Fix; corrections only as new rows	P/L
14.5	Daily summary sent	One message: trades, fills, unfilled, rejections, equity, drawdown, tracking difference, exceptions	Send it	P/L
14.6	Tomorrow ready	AMOs placed and read back (L); paper order file saved (P); morning check time noted	Complete before the AMO window closes	P/L
14.7	Backup	Today's folder copied to the second location	Run backup	P/L
14.8	Sign-off	Your name and time written into the day's log	The day is not finished without it	P/L

Facts to verify with NSE and your broker

The market-structure details in this guide come from general knowledge up to mid-2026, not from sources checked today; confirm each of these before relying on it, because exchange rules, broker policies and fee rates change.

Item	What to confirm	Where
Pre-open session	Exact timings; which stocks participate; how unmatched market orders are carried into the normal market	NSE website / circulars

Item	What to confirm	Where
AMO window	Start and cut-off times; whether market AMOs are allowed; market-protection rules	Your broker's documentation
AMO on ex-dates	Whether the broker cancels or adjusts AMOs for split/bonus ex-dates	Your broker
Price bands	Current band categories; how the base price is set on ex-dates; operating ranges for F&O stocks	NSE circulars
Tick size	Current tick-size slabs by price level	NSE circulars
Bhavcopy	File format (UDiFF), column names, typical publish time	NSE website
Surveillance	ASM / GSM framework stages and their trading restrictions; trade-for-trade series	NSE surveillance pages
Retail algo / API rules	SEBI retail algo framework: static IP, order tagging, order-rate threshold for registration	Your broker; SEBI circulars
Settlement	T+1 credit timing for bought shares; bonus/split credit timelines	Your broker / depository
Charges	STT, stamp duty, exchange transaction charges, SEBI fee, GST, DP charges	Broker charges page; contract notes
Dividend TDS	Current threshold and rate	Your accountant
Capital gains / business income treatment	How your trading frequency will be treated	Your chartered accountant
MWCB thresholds	Current levels and how index points are set each quarter	NSE circulars

This guide is general operational guidance, not legal, tax or investment advice.

Review findings and open items: Gap analysis